

Japan Games and Internet: Our views following new title announcement events: Reiterate Buy ratings on Sony and Capcom

A series of new console game announcement events were held from June 3 to June 9. Specifically, the official PlayStation broadcast “State of Play” was held at 6:00 AM on June 3, the large-scale game announcement event “Summer Game Fest 2026” at 6:00 AM on June 6, the official Xbox broadcast “Xbox Games Showcase 2026” at 2:00 AM on June 8, and the official Nintendo broadcast “Nintendo Direct 2026.6.9” at 11:00 PM on June 9 (all times JST). The major pipeline for 2026 onward, including content newly announced at these events, is shown in [Exhibit 1](#). In 2026, partly because Grand Theft Auto VI, the latest installment in one of the gaming industry’s most iconic IP franchises, is scheduled for release in November 2026, our impression is that major title releases are concentrated in late September through October. In our view, the lineup of titles for PlayStation is strong, giving a positive impression for the Sony Group (Buy). Among publishers, we highlight the standout depth of Capcom’s (Buy) pipeline through 2027, with the announcement of the release of major DLC for Monster Hunter Wilds and Resident Evil Veronica in 2027, as well as the steady expansion of Square Enix’s (Sell) pipeline from a medium- to long-term perspective. As we discuss in detail below, **we reiterate our Buy ratings on: Sony Group, which has a strong pipeline and multiple profit improvement drivers even amid a high-cost environment; and Capcom, whose shares look undervalued despite strong earnings and a robust pipeline. Our detailed views on each company are as follows:**

Minami Munakata
+81(3)4587-9830 |
minami.munakata@gs.com
Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd.

Haruki Kubota
+81(3)4587-4059 |
haruki.kubota@gs.com
Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd.

Platformers

- **Sony Group (Buy):** In addition to Grand Theft Auto VI, the pipeline for FY2026 is strong for both first-party and third-party software. Moreover, amid rising costs, led by memory costs, the company has clearly stated its policy of balancing growth and profitability improvement in its business operations (see [our report dated June 5](#)). Furthermore, with the PlayStation 5 in the latter half of its cycle, Sony appears to be in a relatively good position to manage hardware profitability through adjustments to unit volumes and selling prices, and we see its positioning as favorable compared with Nintendo in that context. We reiterate our Buy rating.
- **Nintendo (Buy):** While the game characteristics of upcoming first-party and third-party software are diverse, suggesting room to attract a broad range of users, the only major first-party title scheduled for release in 2026 is The Legend of Zelda: Ocarina of Time (remake), which is somewhat underwhelming

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compared to market expectation before the event. In Japan, a price increase for the Nintendo Switch 2 console was implemented on May 25, with increases in the US and Europe scheduled for September 1. Based on the precedent of the PS5, which achieved penetration at a pace comparable to the PS4 despite multiple price increases, we believe that from a medium- to long-term perspective, the Nintendo Switch 2 will also achieve steady penetration as the pipeline expands. While it may take time, we believe the share price will gradually begin to recover once sell-through and other actual data confirm solid momentum for the Nintendo Switch 2.

Publishers

- **Capcom (Buy):** While the announcement of major DLC for Monster Hunter Wilds was in line with expectations, we view the announcement that Resident Evil Veronica will be released in 2027 as a positive. In addition to Onimusha: Way of the Sword, announced for release on September 25, the company has already released Pragmata on April 17. In the visual content space, the Street Fighter movie is scheduled for October, and a completely new Resident Evil film is scheduled for sequential release from September onward. We believe the FY3/27 pipeline and event calendar is more robust than those of peers. We reiterate our Buy rating, also considering the shares' attractive valuation (FY2 P/E is now close to sector median along with robust profit growth).
- **Square Enix (Sell):** FINAL FANTASY VII REVELATION, the third installment of the FINAL FANTASY VII Remake trilogy, was announced for release in spring 2027, and the release of several other new titles was also announced, giving us the impression that preparations for new title launches are progressing steadily. In addition, while no release date was announced for Dragon Quest XII, which is currently in development, the company provided a long-awaited update, unveiling a significant overhaul of the game's concept along with gameplay footage. The content suggests that the initiatives under the current medium-term plan, which the company has positioned as "a three-year reboot," are bearing fruit, and our medium- to long-term impression is positive. However, the company remains in a structural reform execution phase in the near term, and we maintain our Sell rating given relatively stretched valuations (FY2 P/E of 26x is well above the global game sector's median of 16x).
- **Bandai Namco (Sell):** While release dates for major titles such as Ace Combat 8: Wings of Theve and ELDEN RING Tarnished Edition were announced, along with the announcement that GUNDAM ROGUE ORBIT, a completely new Mobile Suit Gundam action game, will be released in 2027, we cannot conclude at this point that the probability of achieving the company's 2H FY3/27 operating profit guidance for the digital business (which implies an 87% yoy increase) has increased. Our view that the digital business guidance is somewhat optimistic remains unchanged. We maintain our Sell rating.

Exhibit 1: Schedule for the release of major game titles

Title	Publisher	Switch 2	PS5	Xbox X/S	Release date
Power-Pro 2026-2027	Konami	✓	✓		6/11/2026
The Adventures of Elliot: Millennium Tales	Square Enix	✓	✓	✓	6/18/2026
Devil May Cry 5: Devil Hunter Edition	Capcom	✓			6/23/2026
Star Fox	Nintendo	✓			6/25/2026
DEAD OR ALIVE 6 Last Round	Koei Tecmo		✓	✓	6/25/2026
Rhythm Heaven Groove	Nintendo	✓			7/2/2026
Echoes of Aincrad	Bandai Namco		✓	✓	7/9/2026
Digimon Story Time Stranger for Nintendo Switch 2	Bandai Namco	✓			7/9/2026
Assasin's Creed Black Flag RE: Synchro	Ubisoft		✓	✓	7/9/2026
Palworld 1.0	Pocket Pair		✓	✓	7/10/2026
Pro Baseball Spirits 2026	Konami		✓		7/16/2026
Splatoon Raiders	Nintendo	✓			7/23/2026
Halo: Campaign Evolved	Xbox Game Studios		✓	✓	7/28/2026
Xenoblade 2: Nintendo Switch 2 Edition	Nintendo	✓			7/30/2026
Beast of Reincarnation	Game Freak		✓	✓	8/4/2026
MARVEL: Tōkon Fighting Souls	SIE		✓		8/7/2026
STAR WARS ZERO COMPANY	Electronic Arts		✓	✓	8/27/2026
METAL GEAR SOLID: MASTER COLLECTION Vol.2	Konami	✓	✓	✓	8/27/2026
BRIGANDINE ABYSS	Happinet	✓	✓	✓	8/27/2026
ELDEN RING Tarnished Edition	Bandai Namco	✓			8/28/2026
The Blood of Dawnwalker	Bandai Namco		✓	✓	9/3/2026
Marvel's Wolverine	SIE		✓		9/15/2026
Fire Emblem: Fortune's Weave	Nintendo	✓			9/17/2026
Control Resonant	Remedy Entertainment		✓	✓	9/24/2026
SILENT HILL: Townfall	Konami		✓		9/24/2026
ONIMUSHA: Way of the sword	Capcom	✓	✓	✓	9/25/2026
Minecraft Dungeons II	Xbox Game Studios	✓	✓	✓	9/29/2026
Rayman Legends Retold	Ubisoft	✓	✓	✓	10/1/2026
Dynasty Warriors 2 Remastered	Koei Tecmo	✓	✓	✓	10/1/2026
ACE COMBAT 8: WINGS OF THEVE	Bandai Namco		✓	✓	10/2/2026
Gears of War: E-Day	Xbox Game Studios			✓	10/6/2026
KINGDOM HEARTS Collection I~III	Square Enix	✓	✓	✓	10/8/2026
Dragon's Dogma II: Dark Arisen	Capcom	✓	✓	✓	10/9/2026
Castlevania: Belmont's Curse	Konami	✓	✓	✓	10/15/2026
Final Fantasy Resonance	Square Enix	✓	✓	✓	10/22/2026
Nintendo Switch Sports Resort	Nintendo	✓			10/22/2026
ONE PIECE: Grand Gourmet	Bandai Namco	✓			10/22/2026
Sanrio Party Land	Sanrio Games	✓			10/29/2026
Metaphor: ReFantazio (Nintendo Switch 2 ver.)	ATLUS	✓			11/12/2026
Grand Theft Auto VI	Rockstar Games		✓	✓	11/19/2026
Xenoblade 3: Nintendo Switch 2 Edition	Nintendo	✓			12/3/2026
DRAGON QUEST MONSTERS: The Withered World	Square Enix	✓	✓	✓	12/4/2026
The Legend of Zelda: Ocarina of Time	Nintendo	✓			2026
Professor Layton and the New World	LEVEL5	✓			2026
The Duskbloods	FromSoftware	✓			2026
ANANTA	NetEase Games		✓		2026
NOBUNAGA'S AMBITION: Hishou	Koei Tecmo	✓	✓		This Winter
Stranger than Heaven	SEGA		✓	✓	1/15/2027
Tomb Raider: Legacy of Atlantis	Amazon Games		✓	✓	2/12/2027
PERSONA 4 REVIVAL	ATLUS		✓	✓	2/18/2027
Fable	Xbox Game Studios			✓	2/23/2027
METRO 2039	Deep Silver		✓	✓	Feb 2027
Wo Long 2: Wings of Ember	Koei Tecmo	✓	✓	✓	Early 2027
Atelier Karia: The Night Kingdom & the Guide of Memories	Koei Tecmo	✓	✓	✓	Early 2027
FINAL FANTASY VII REVELATION	Square Enix	✓	✓	✓	2027 Spring
Pokémon Winds & Pokémon Waves	Nintendo	✓			2027
Xenoblade Genesis	Nintendo	✓			2027
Until Dawn 2	SIE		✓		2027
Monster Hunter Wilds: Ascendance	Capcom	✓	✓	✓	2027
Resident Evil Veronica	Capcom	✓	✓	✓	2027
Mega Man: Dual Override	Capcom	✓	✓	✓	2027
Dragonball Xenoverse 3	Bandai Namco		✓	✓	2027
Digimon Story Time Stranger: DLC	Bandai Namco	✓	✓	✓	2027
GUNDAM ROGUE ORBIT	Bandai Namco		✓	✓	2027
VIRTUA FIGHTER CROSSROADS	SEGA		TBD		2027
CRAZY TAXI World Tour	SEGA	✓	✓	✓	2027
GOD OF WAR LAWFEY	SIE		✓		TBD

Green highlight denotes titles released by overseas publishers

Source: Company data

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Sony Group**Our 12-month target price of ¥4,100** is based on a sum-of-the-parts (SOTP) valuation.

Our base year for the valuation is FY3/29E. Key downside risks to our target price include: (1) G&NS business; (i) Lower-than-expected PS5 hardware unit sales; (ii)

lower-than-expected revenue per console unit due to delays in the launch of new software, live service games, and downloadable content (DLC) from first and third parties, or weaker-than-expected performance of these offerings; and (iii) deterioration in hardware profitability due to higher promotion expenses or component costs. (2) Pictures business: Slower-than-expected growth in paying subscribers at anime streaming platform Crunchyroll, which we consider a key driver of earnings in this segment, or higher-than-expected promotion and marketing expenses. (3) I&SS business: Slower growth in the market for CMOS image sensors for mobile devices, ASP declines due to intensifying competition (particularly from Chinese companies), or deterioration in product yields due to increasing manufacturing difficulty accompanying performance improvements in CMOS image sensors.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Nintendo

Our 12-month target price of ¥10,500 is based on FY3/29E EV/NOPAT. Our target EV/NOPAT multiple is 20.1X. We base our applied multiple on the average FY3E EV/NOPAT over the past year. Key downside risks to our target price are (1) Nintendo Switch 2: Sales falling short of our forecasts. (2) Active console units: If the momentum of the existing Nintendo Switch slows more than expected due to the transition to the successor console, this could result in the number of active console units on the Nintendo Switch platform falling short of our forecasts. (3) Pipeline: The delayed release of major titles, mainly first-party titles, and lower-than-expected unit sales. (4) Hardware profitability: Profitability of hardware sales deteriorating more than we expect due to a greater-than-expected rise in component costs and delays in passing on prices.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Capcom

Our 12-month target price of ¥4,200 is based on FY3/28E EV/NOPAT. Our target EV/NOPAT multiple of 21.3X is a 25% premium to the FY27 median of 17.0X for the global games sector. Key downside risks to our target price are (1) Pipeline: If the release of major titles is delayed, this could introduce volatility to the annual pipeline and lead to downside risk to new title sales volume. (2) Impairment: If user preferences change, this could lead to the cancellation of content development and/or the booking of large impairment losses due to weak performance of new titles. (3) Erosion of IP Value: If the company excessively focuses on game software pricing strategies, this could lead to a steeper-than-expected decline in unit prices, particularly for old titles, eroding IP value.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Square Enix Holdings

Our 12-month target price of ¥2,100 is based on FY3/27E EV/NOPAT. Our target EV/NOPAT multiple of 13.5X is a 25% discount to the FY26 median of 18.0X for the global games sector. Key upside risks to our target price are: (1) HD game pipeline: We currently assume no major title launches that are likely to record annual shipments of more than 5 mn units in the short term, but new AAA titles could be announced and released, driving HD game earnings. (2) Mobile game performance: We assume that mobile game sales will continue on a downward trend. However, a major new title could be launched, and sales in this business could shift to an upward trend sooner than we expect. (3) Structural reforms: We expect meaningful benefits from structural reforms to start emerging from FY3/27, but margin improvement in the game business could occur earlier than we assume, and earnings could enter a period of significant expansion.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Bandai Namco Holdings

Our 12-month target price of ¥3,300 is based on SoTP: Toys and Hobby business: We use FY3/28 as the base year for our valuation. We apply the FY2E EV/NOPAT median of 11.4x of six global toy & hobby related companies. Other businesses including the Digital business: We apply the FY2E EV/NOPAT median of 15.8x for the seven Japanese games companies in our coverage.

Key upside risks are (1) Toys and Hobby business: Better-than-expected sales of high-target products centered on Gunpla and card games; stronger-than-expected momentum for the One Piece, Dragon Ball, and Mobile Suit Gundam IPs, mainly overseas; Lower-than-expected costs led by improvement in macroeconomic environment; (2) Mobile games: Higher-than-expected sales due to major new hit titles; better-than-expected margin improvement due to the spread of payments outside of app stores and optimization of operating costs; and (3) Console: Higher-than-expected sales due to major new hit titles and growth in repeat sales; better-than-expected profitability improvement from the company's focus on reviewing its development structure and rebuilding its title portfolio.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Minami Munakata and Haruki Kubota, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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Contributing Authors: Minami Munakata Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd., Haruki Kubota Goldman Sachs Japan Co., Ltd..

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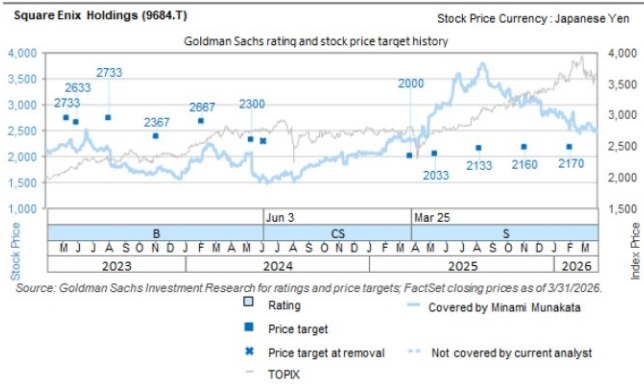
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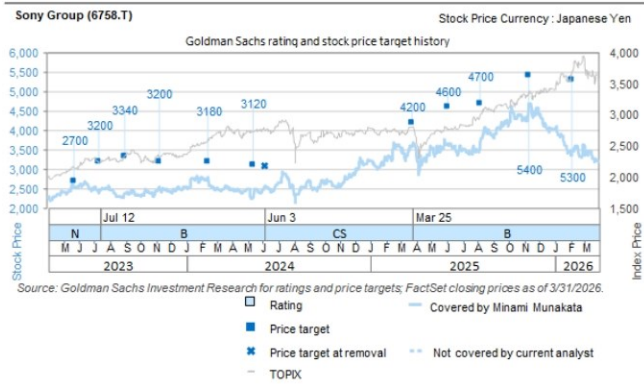
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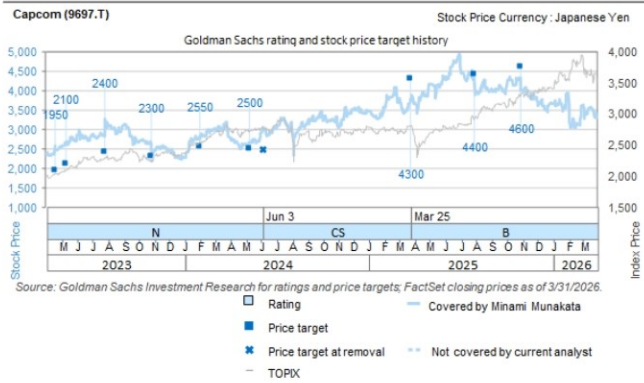
Price target and rating history chart(s)



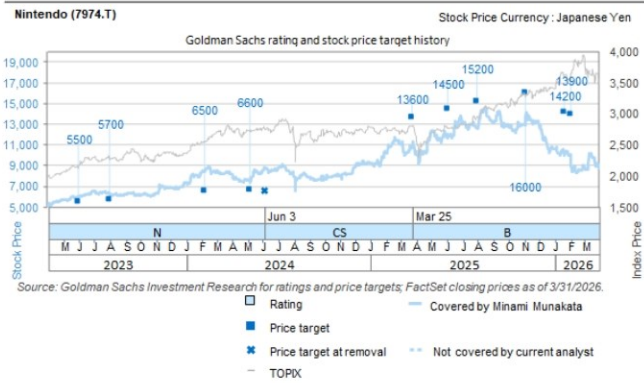
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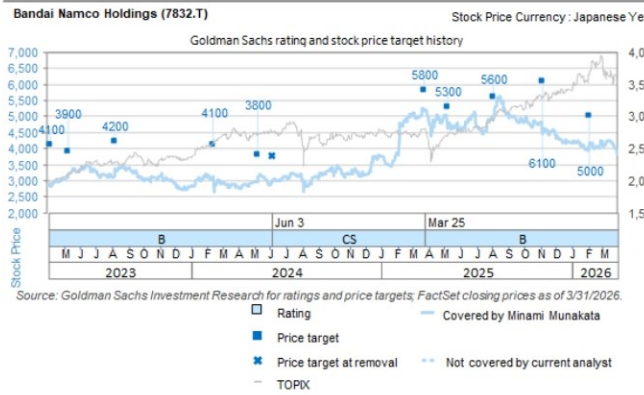
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Target price history table(s)

Sony Group (6758.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
08-May-26	4,100	3,114
12-Apr-26	4,800	3,325
05-Feb-26	5,300	3,348
11-Nov-25	5,400	4,520
07-Aug-25	4,700	3,680
04-Jun-25	4,600	3,670
25-Mar-25	4,200	3,591
14-May-24	15,600	2,282
14-Feb-24	15,900	2,796
09-Nov-23	16,000	2,525
01-Sep-23	16,700	2,390
12-Jul-23	16,000	2,374

Nintendo (7974.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
08-May-26	10,500	7,667
12-Apr-26	12,300	8,300
03-Feb-26	13,900	10,080
22-Jan-26	14,200	9,950
04-Nov-25	16,000	12,945
01-Aug-25	15,200	12,595
04-Jun-25	14,500	12,090
25-Mar-25	13,600	10,765
07-May-24	6,600	7,759
06-Feb-24	6,500	8,376
03-Aug-23	5,700	6,357

Bandai Namco Holdings (7832.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
14-May-26	3,300	3,804
12-Apr-26	4,600	3,854
05-Feb-26	5,000	4,007
06-Nov-25	6,100	4,472
05-Aug-25	5,600	4,989
08-May-25	5,300	4,617
25-Mar-25	5,800	5,193
09-May-24	3,800	2,975
14-Feb-24	4,100	3,118
08-Aug-23	4,200	3,173

Capcom (9697.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
12-Apr-26	4,200	3,319
29-Oct-25	4,600	4,325
30-Jul-25	4,400	4,283
25-Mar-25	4,300	3,764
09-May-24	2,500	2,646
31-Jan-24	5,100	2,823
26-Oct-23	4,600	2,642
26-Jul-23	4,800	2,832

Square Enix Holdings (9684.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
14-May-26	2,100	2,476
12-Apr-26	2,030	2,535
05-Feb-26	2,170	2,555
06-Nov-25	2,160	3,022
08-Aug-25	6,400	3,685
14-May-25	6,100	2,885
25-Mar-25	6,000	2,291
13-May-24	6,900	2,089
05-Feb-24	8,000	1,970
07-Nov-23	7,100	1,695
04-Aug-23	8,200	2,122

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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